

Cordillera Blanca

Part of the Andes, this is the largest tropical mountain range in the world. Peaks over 19,685 ft (6,000 m) high surround valleys filled with lakes and streams. There isn't much oxygen at these heights, so it is hard to breathe, but the animals here manage surprisingly well.

Taruca

You can tell a taruca apart from other deer by the dark, Y-shaped mark on its face. It feeds on mountain grasses, and travels into valleys to find water.



The guanaco is the ancestor of domestic llamas. The closely related vicuña is the ancestor of domestic alpacas.

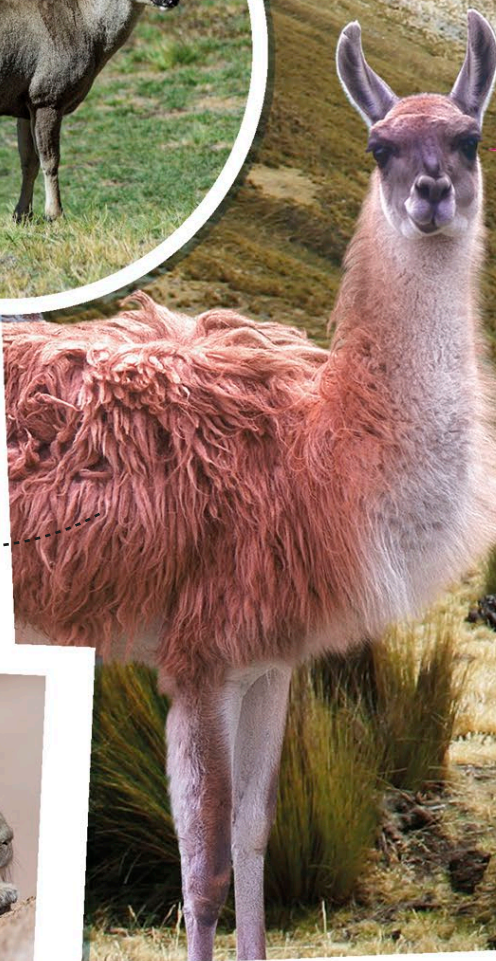


Vizcachas are related to chinchillas.

Andean condor Female condors produce just one egg every two years. It takes almost 60 days for the egg to hatch.



Guanaco The guanaco is a member of the camel family. Movable pads on its hooves help it walk over rocky ground.



Andean goose The Andean goose lives in mountain wetlands, but it doesn't swim well, so it avoids the water!



Colocolo The colocolo is a nocturnal predator that hunts rodents, guinea pigs, and ground-nesting birds.



Southern mountain vizcacha

The rabbitlike vizcacha spends a lot of time on rocky ledges, basking in the sun. It is covered in thick, soft fur all the way to the end of its curled tail.

The colocolo resembles a house cat, but can be identified by the dark-colored bands and lines around its legs.